‘frailties’ is, frankly, a crock of shit. As I mentioned, sometimes when my head moves – especially early on in an innings – I will plant my foot and get trapped lbw. That aside, my defence has been as solid as you can get. But I guess most of my opposition probably say, ‘Stay patient with Hersch and he’ll give you a chance or two. He likes to free his arms and hit through the covers. You’ve always got a chance with a straight ball.’

Another aspect of my game I’m proud of is my BMT … my big-match temperament. I love the big games, particularly World Cup games, and my averages there speak for themselves: 1 067 runs in 23 innings, averaging 56 runs and a strike rate of 87.38. A World Cup is the most pressurised form of the game you can play in any sport. You are playing for your country, and it’s the one platform on which you really want to perform. I am prouder of my World Cup record than anything else, and I believe the record exists because of my ability to handle the pressure inherent in the situation. From an early age I wanted to be the guy who scores the big runs, the match-winning goal or the try in a final. I don’t think there’s one particular element in my make-up that makes me perform well in a big match, but, from my school days, if my team was in a final, they knew that I’d do anything to help them win the game, and that, in turn, boosted their confidence. And their belief in me motivated me even more.

I am definitely always determined not to let any situation get the better of me, and love performing for people on the big stage. From my school days, I’ve wanted to entertain crowds, and an element of showmanship has always been a part of my game. I won’t lie; I love the glory too. I like taking centre stage and getting the attention – it motivates, focuses and brings out the best in me.

The famous 438 game at the Wanderers against Australia in 2006 is a perfect example. With the ODI series locked at 2-2, the fifth game was essentially a final. The Aussies posted a record score of 434, and with my innings of 175 off 111 balls, we managed to chase their total down. It was the ideal platform for me to do what I do best, and I did it. The greater the glory, the bigger the outcome, the more I’m up for it.

On the flip side, it’s been fascinating to watch players who have scored more runs than I have, and who have better averages, fall apart completely in a final. Despite having all the experience in the world, when they are put in a do-or-die situation, the wheels come off. Take a look at the IPL finals over the past few years. Just about all the big names have had a mental